



Adorable Drones

Want some cute, adorable drones? Here are some suggestions.
<http://dgit.in/Re-drones>



LA Philharmonic: In VR

You can soon watch the orchestra perform using VR headsets. Read here:
<http://dgit.in/symphonyVR>

Logoing on

How Lo can you Go? (Here in the typography the 'Lo' and the 'Go' should be distinctly different from the rest. Basically, you should see Lo Go immediately when you look at it)

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After Google changed its logo – boy, were there waves! Not destructive, landscape altering waves, but waves that push you just enough to make you lose balance.

Google changed its newspaper-reminiscent typeface in September with that of a child who was let loose with a crayon and a penchant to watch the world burn. The quaint looking lowercase 'g' present on all our tabs turned into a multi-coloured, grotesque uppercase 'G'. Gmail would never be the same again.

Or so we thought, and always do when a logo of a brand we know and love changes. There is confusion at first, then anger, and then, after a healthy amount of ranting on the internet, we make peace



The new, and mostly hated, Google logo.

with it, as usual. The old logo already begins to look outdated, and we decide to get on with our lives.

And so the question arises

Do these logo changes really mean anything? Under all that marketing jargon is there something of value being carried out here or are we at the mercy of bored designers and fidgety brand managers?

Take, for example, Quora, the forum of intelligent or at-the-least earnest procrastinators where questions can be asked and interesting answers expected. When

Quora changed its logo, it looked like it hardly changed anything. The tip of the Q seemed longer and the 'r' had become rounder. That's it. You might wonder why anyone was paid to do this – and you would stumble across a lengthy explanation for it.

The logo was changed because the 'r' and the 'a' met at a weird angle, the logo looked cluttered when its size was reduced, and because there was a lot of 'noise' in the logo, among other things. Noise here is the unevenness of the top of the letters of the old logo which doesn't allow your eyes to travel smoothly over it.

But there was an angle of manipulation too in all this! The new font used here was Baskerville, a font which, filmmaker Errol Morris concluded with a convenient social experiment, that "promotes, engenders a belief that a sentence is true," which means that you now are in possession of a very useful life hack.

These do sound like good enough reasons which could seep into our minds slowly over time and thus be significant.

But then what about the new Lenovo logo? This new logo looks very similar to its previous one at first glance, with the prominent change being that the font is no more in italics. The company says that it now looks more personal. Yes of course, of course it looks more personal. But the important part here is that the logo is now enclosed in a rectangle, which can be filled with any image by its partners. That is a more tangible outcome of reworking a logo.

And then we come to Facebook's new logo. Hold the two logos aside and try to spot the difference. We'll wait. Facebook here turned the two-story 'a' to a one-story

'a', and made the letters a bit thinner. They did it to make the logo "approachable and friendly". So now you know who to turn to when you've had a bad day.



Shield your eyes from this drastic change!

Isn't this marketing speak?

Before you dismiss all these hoopla and begin to believe that these logo changes are merely the experiment of a restless imagination, you may witness the buzzword for any new logo-nowadays – it's mobile-friendly.

Logos of technology companies are going the simple, flat, and thus more mobile-friendly route. Flipkart changed its logo from the shopping cart racing past to its iconic 'f' on a shopping bag to make it more mobile-friendly. Google changed its logo to also make it more flat, and clean, and thus more mobile-friendly as the previous logos were designed keeping desktops in mind. The Lenovo logo too was changed to make it more (déjà vu), mobile-friendly.

And this trend, some believe, is taking the fun out of the logo world. Shadowing has been stripped off, nice round buttons which actually look like they can be pressed have been stripped off, and we are witnessing the shift from skeuomorphism to the commonly seen flat design which begun since around 2012.